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# GENOCIDE AND INTERNATIONAL LAW

If the primary driver for the abuse of the Rohingyas had simply been the repression by the military regime aimed at all the population of Burma, then there would be grounds for hope that the transition to a more democratic regime would mitigate the problems.[1] However, while in the past the worst of the violence has often been orchestrated by the regime, and has been linked to periods of wider political upheaval, animosity towards the Rohingyas has now become generalised and deep-seated across the Burmese political spectrum. The state has accepted no responsibility for the 2012–13 massacres and members of the opposition NLD also claim that the Rohingyas are in fact Bengalis and recent immigrants:

> [I]n an interview with GlobalPost, the Nobel Peace Laureate's spokesman and confidante, Nyan Win, confirmed that Aung San Suu Kyi has no plans to champion the Rohingya cause despite criticism swirling around her silence on the crisis. … 'She believes, in Burma, there is no Rohingya ethnic group. It is a made-up name of the Bengali. So she can't say anything about Rohingya. But there is international pressure for her to speak about Rohingya. It's a problem.'[2]

In addition, as identified earlier, Buddhist extremists are becoming more influential, not least by offering basic education and social services for the poor of Myanmar. Many people will accept their version of Buddhist teachings, and their emphasis on the incompatibility of allowing Muslims to be part of the country, simply due to a lack of alternative sources of information.

Overall, there is now a real risk that a very vulnerable group, with no international diaspora to speak up for it (except the hundreds of thousands of refugees in Bangladesh, Thailand and other countries in the region, who are often themselves in conditions that are little better than those of the Rohingyas interred in Myanmar's internal refugee camps), now face a